170,000 species) are pollinated by 200,000 animal species. Typically, a pollinating insect is attracted to a flower by its colours or scent to drink nectar or collect pollen, and pollen attaches to part of the insect's body to be carried to the next flower, where it is deposited. The flower and its pollinator have evolved to make this mechanism work effectively.

Some plants have also evolved a service-resource relationship in which birds and mammals disperse their seeds, spores, or fruit. Seeds may become attached to the fur of a mammal browsing the plant's leaves; when the mammal wanders away, it disperses the seed. The vile odor of stinkhorn fungi attracts flies, which lick the fungi's slime and thence disperse their spores. When a bird swallows a fruit, it carries the seeds with it as it flies away; the indigestible seeds may be excreted in faeces far from where they were eaten. In all these situations, the plants provide a resource (food) and the mammals, flies, and birds provide a service (transport).

However, not all mutualistic relationships involve plants. In Africa, birds named oxpeckers and herbivorous mammals such as impalas and zebras practise another kind of service-resource mutualism. The oxpeckers pick ticks from the mammals' fur, removing irritation and a source of disease, while at the same time having a meal. Oxpeckers also make loud calls when they sense danger, alerting the mammal host as well as other oxpeckers.

In the insect world, some ants and aphids carry out a different form of service-resource mutualism. While the aphids feed on plants, the ants protect the aphids. Subsequently, the ants consume the honeydew that the aphids release, using a "milking" process on their smaller partners, by stroking them with their antennae.

Service-service mutualisms, in which both organisms offer each other protection, are far less common. One unusual relationship takes place in the western Pacific Ocean, between around 30 species of clownfish and 10 species of venomous sea anemones. The sea anemones' stinging, toxin-filled nematocysts, or capsules, on their tentacles kill most small fish that